FOUNDER MODE · FACILITATOR REFERENCE · v2

Print and laminate. Same cards, same board, same dice. Two modes.

FOUNDER JUNIOR

Ages 8-12 · 30-45 minutes

SETUP

Each player: $3,000 · Player Mat · HQ Tile (Vacant). Draw 3 Problem Cards, keep 1, match an Industry Card. Strong Match: 1 free Customer Token. Name your business.

EVERY ROUND

1 CHAOS: draw 1 card (Round 3+), use the Junior shortcut printed on money cards. 2 ACTIONS: each player takes 2. 3 COLLECT: customers x $5. Boom x2 · Festival x3 · Recession half (round up to $5). 4 PAY: Base $20 + HQ Rent $30 + $20 per Employee.

ACTIONS

PITCH: draw a card, pick an approach, roll 2d6, hit the target = 1 customer. Doubles on a miss = customer anyway. BUY HQ $1,500: from now on draw 2 Pitch Cards and choose 1. HIRE $120 (needs HQ, max 2): +1 Pitch action every round, $20/round payroll. MURAL $300 (once): take 1 customer now, then +$2 per customer every round. BUSK (Music only): roll 1d6, collect x $10; on 5-6 also +1 customer.

CAN'T PAY?

Lose 3 customers. Keep playing. Nobody sits out.

HOW TO WIN

First founder to 12 Customer Tokens wins. One condition. Clean race.

GRADUATION

Winners are ready for Standard. Same cards, deeper rules. Run one Junior game, then one Standard game in the same session.

FOUNDER STANDARD

Ages 13+ · 45-60 minutes

SETUP

Each player: $5,000 · Mat · HQ Tile · Cap Table at 100% · chip row. Problems and Strong Match as Junior. Shuffle Chaos Deck. Investor Cards face-up.

EVERY ROUND

1 CHAOS (Round 3+): apply immediately. 2 ACTIONS: two each. 3 SETTLE: customers +1 row per Employee, read your column, collect. Food on Festival: both Festival and Normal. Boom or Festival: $20 to the Trust Pool. 4 OVERHEAD: pay chips; check a Sovereignty box if a declared Run was profitable.

COLUMNS

RECESSION 1 left · NORMAL home · BOOM home with Mural Token · FESTIVAL 2 right. Net shifts stop at the strip edges. Mural holders read Normal during Recession.

OVERHEAD / ROUND

Base $20/$10 · HQ Rent $50/$30 · Employee $60/$40 each (max 3, each = +1 strip row) · GM $250/$150 (needed for Sovereignty). Manual / Auto values. Bankruptcy: Comeback Loan $1,500 once.

CAPS

Manual founders: 12 customers max, read to row 12. Automated: 15, rows 13-15 unlock. Automate at the Tech Hub: AI $3,000 · Tech $3,500 · others $5,000.

INVESTORS (pitch 7+)

Park Angel: 8+ cust + profitable = $10K / 15%. Park 2nd Look: failed card + 10 cust = $15K / 15%. Chase VC: automated + 15 cust = $50K / 20%. Chase Conviction: automated + Mural = $100K / 25%. Sovereign Fund: Mural + 1 Mentor Action before your Run = $8K / 5%.

WIN

GM placed, Run declared, 3 straight profitable Mentor rounds. Tie: most cash.

CLASSROOM GUIDE · 40 to 60 minute window

No prior business knowledge required. The game does the teaching. You do the pausing.

BEFORE CLASS (10 minutes)

Print one Player Mat per student and pre-cut the Pitch and Chaos decks. Set $3,000 (Junior) or $5,000 (Standard) at each seat. Chaos deck and Trust Pool bowl at each table center. Optional: pre-assign Industry Cards to speed setup, but let every student name their own business. Always.

MOMENTS WORTH PAUSING FOR

First rejection: ask what information the miss just gave them. Rejection is data. First Recession card: ask who held a Mural and why they landed on Normal while everyone else fell. That is a moat. First Investor deal: slow down the Cap Table slide. You just took $10,000. What did you give up? First Sovereignty declaration: the table goes quiet. Ask what it feels like to own a business that runs without you. That question is worth more than any card in the box.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT · US grades 5 to 10

Payout Strip	Multiplication as lookup table, ratio and proportion (6.RP.A)
Cap Table Slider	Percentages, part-whole relationships (7.RP.A.3)
Community Trust split	Division with remainders, rounding rules (5.NBT.B.6)
Overhead Phase	Multi-step addition and subtraction with money (4.MD.A.2)
Employee row bonus	Additive reasoning on a table, unit rate thinking (6.RP.A.2)
Sovereignty condition	Inequality, profit vs loss (6.NS.B)
Investor deck	Percent decrease, net worth (7.RP.A.3, HSF-IF)
Chaos Deck	Probability literacy, expected value reasoning (7.SP.C)

RUNNING BOTH MODES IN ONE SESSION

Start with Junior: the race to 12 teaches pitching and probability in 30 minutes. Winners get the Standard rulebook on the spot. Kids who hit 12 customers will demand the harder mode. That demand is the lesson landing.